WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

NAMIBIA

Africa

Information current as of October 2026

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WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Windhoek	Capital and administrative centre; home to the Bank of Namibia, the Namibia Investment Promotion and Development Board (NIPDB) and the main banking and professional-services community	Financial services, administration, ICT, retail
Walvis Bay (Erongo)	Deep-water Atlantic port and hub of the Walvis Bay Corridors serving landlocked neighbours, with corridor cargo volumes above 2.5 million tonnes; a natural support base for offshore oil activity	Port logistics, transit trade, oil and gas services, fishing
Erongo uranium belt (Husab, Rössing, Langer Heinrich)	Namibia is the world's third-largest uranium producer, with 12.2% of global output in 2024; uranium earned N$28.1 billion, or 31% of export revenue, in 2025	Uranium mining, mining services, engineering
Orange Basin offshore (south)	Site of the Venus and Mopane discoveries; Venus targets about 150,000 barrels a day, with a final investment decision expected in Q4 2026	Oil and gas, offshore supply chain, marine services
Lüderitz / //Karas region	Southern coastal region with strong solar and wind resources, host to the planned Hyphen green hydrogen and ammonia project	Green hydrogen, renewable energy, port development
Northern regions and Zambezi	Most populous part of the country and a gateway for trade with Angola and Zambia; crop output grew 28.5% year-on-year in Q2 2026	Agriculture, agro-processing, cross-border trade
Export Processing Zones and planned Special Economic Zones	EPZ companies exporting outside SACU enjoy corporate tax, VAT and customs exemptions; a Special Economic Zone Bill is being prepared for Parliament	Export manufacturing, processing, logistics

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- Namibia Investment Promotion and Development Board (NIPDB): national investment promotion agency, operating a One-Stop Centre to streamline procedures for investors
- Namibia Investment Promotion and Facilitation Bill, under detailed review after public consultation, setting out performance-based incentives and the future framework for investor rights and sector access

- Export Processing Zone regime (exemption from corporate tax, VAT, customs duty and stamp duty for qualifying exporters) and a Special Economic Zone Bill under legal review, with the SEZ tax regime also being reviewed
- Corporate tax at 31%, with legacy registered-manufacturer incentives (18% rate and enhanced allowances) being phased out, and an 80% export allowance on qualifying manufactured exports
- Namibian dollar pegged one-to-one to the South African rand within the Common Monetary Area, with exchange-control approvals handled by the Bank of Namibia through authorised dealers
- Petroleum exploration licences awarded with the state oil company NAMCOR, which typically holds around 10% (as at Venus and Mopane), with upstream oversight coordinated by a petroleum unit in the Presidency
- Exit from the FATF grey list in June 2026 after all 13 action items were addressed, easing correspondent banking and due-diligence processes for investors

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Namibia in October 2026 offers political stability, sound institutions and one of Africa's most significant emerging energy frontiers. Growth has picked up: GDP rose 4.8% year-on-year in Q2 2026, the strongest pace since early 2024, after 3.1% in Q1, led by services (+6.1%), agriculture (+17.8%) and manufacturing (+3.9%), and following 1.7% growth in 2025. Net FDI inflows reached N$6.6 billion in Q3 2025, up about 22% year-on-year and driven mainly by mining. Policy credibility has been reinforced: Namibia redeemed its $750 million Eurobond in October 2025, exited the FATF grey list in June 2026 ahead of schedule, and the Bank of Namibia holds the repo rate at 6.75% with reserves of N$58 billion (about $3.6 billion), or 3.6 months of import cover, at end-July 2026. Investment and Special Economic Zone legislation is under review, and TotalEnergies' Venus field, targeting about 150,000 barrels a day, is expected to reach a final investment decision in Q4 2026.

Namibia's central structural challenge is turning resource wealth into broad-based employment. Unemployment stood at 36.9% in the 2023 census labour report, and the IMF notes that growth has been concentrated in public and extractive sectors, while public debt is projected at around 66% of GDP in 2026 as the government absorbs lower customs-union (SACU) receipts. The policy response is practical and well defined: the FY2026/27 budget targets consolidation through wage-bill and medical-scheme reform, and the authorities are prioritising faster permitting, a workable local-content policy, digitalisation and skills alignment. The opportunity is substantial: offshore oil, with first Venus oil expected around 2030 and Mopane targeting a decision in 2027–28, green hydrogen, expanding uranium output and a fast-growing agricultural sector together create long-term demand for capital, skills, logistics and services partners.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Unemployment and skills gaps	Unemployment of 36.9% (2023 census) and skills mismatches limit how quickly growth translates into jobs and can raise expectations on local hiring	Investors that build training and local supplier programmes are well placed for licensing and local-content goodwill, and can draw on a young workforce
Public finances and SACU revenue swings	Public debt is projected at around 66% of GDP in 2026, and lower SACU receipts widened the FY2025/26 deficit	The FY2026/27 budget targets consolidation, the 2025 Eurobond was repaid in full, and a deep domestic pension and insurance sector supports local financing
Reliance on mining and diamond demand	Mining contracted 3.1% in Q2 2026 as uranium, diamond and metal-ore output eased, and natural-diamond demand remains soft	Diversification into oil, green hydrogen, agriculture and services is under way, and world-class uranium assets benefit from rising global nuclear demand
Timing of offshore oil decisions	No final investment decision has yet been taken; Venus is expected in Q4 2026 and Mopane in 2027–28, with first oil around 2030	Supply-chain, port and services investors can position early, with TotalEnergies indicating a path to about 350,000 barrels a day of operated capacity
Evolving investment and empowerment rules	The Investment Promotion and Facilitation Bill, SEZ Bill and the NEEEF empowerment framework are still being finalised, and some sectors may be reserved for local	Engage in the consultation process through NIPDB and business chambers, and structure local partnerships early

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
	firms below set thresholds	
Inflation and interest rates	Inflation rose to 5.4% in September 2026, led by fuel costs, and the repo rate was raised to 6.75% in June	The rand peg anchors monetary policy, and the central bank forecasts inflation of around 4% for 2026 and 3.9% for 2027; hedge rand exposure as standard
Logistics readiness for oil and hydrogen	Ports, FPSO support and subsea services must scale up ahead of first oil and hydrogen exports	This gap is itself an investment opportunity in port, storage, marine and engineering services around Walvis Bay and Lüderitz

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Namibia's risk profile is that of a stable, well-governed democracy with credible institutions, a currency anchored to the rand and a financial sector described by the IMF as liquid and well capitalised. Recent milestones, including the full repayment of the 2025 Eurobond and an ahead-of-schedule exit from the FATF grey list in June 2026, show policy delivery. The principal considerations are fiscal pressure from lower SACU receipts, high unemployment and a growth base still concentrated in mining, together with the timing of offshore oil investment decisions and the finalisation of new investment, SEZ and empowerment legislation. Each is being addressed through budget consolidation, regulatory reform and diversification into energy, agriculture and services. Investors should plan for evolving local-content and empowerment requirements and build realistic timelines for oil and hydrogen projects, while recognising that Namibia's frontier energy resources and strategic position on the Atlantic coast offer long-term upside.

MARKET ACCESS

Namibia is a member of the Southern African Customs Union (SACU), the Common Monetary Area and the Southern African Development Community (SADC), giving duty-free access to South Africa and the wider regional market, and is a party to the African Continental Free Trade Area and a WTO member. It trades with the EU under the SADC–EU Economic Partnership Agreement, and the US extended AGOA preferences through December 2028 in September 2026. Exports reached N$90.4 billion in 2025, led by uranium, gold, fish and diamonds, with South Africa (N$26.6 billion), China (N$22 billion), the EU (N$17.6 billion) and Botswana (N$9.3 billion) the main markets. The port of Walvis Bay and its road and rail corridors link Namibia to Botswana, Zambia, the DRC and South Africa, positioning the country as an Atlantic gateway for southern Africa.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the President (Netumbo Nandi-Ndaitwah)	Sets national economic priorities and hosts the upstream petroleum unit overseeing oil and gas development	Primary reference point for Namibia's strategic direction and energy policy
Namibia Investment Promotion and Development Board (NIPDB)	National investment promotion agency running the One-Stop Centre and supporting economic diversification	Standard first point of contact for market entry, incentives and project facilitation
Bank of Namibia	Monetary authority; maintains the peg to the rand, sets the repo rate and administers exchange controls	Relevant for currency, banking and capital-repatriation matters
Ministry of Finance	Leads fiscal policy, tax reform and the investment-related tax and SEZ regimes, and led the FATF exit process	Key counterpart on tax incentives, budget priorities and financing frameworks
Ministry of Industries, Mines and Energy (Petroleum Commissioner)	Licenses mining and petroleum activity and approves upstream transactions such as the Mopane operatorship transfer	Essential for licensing and regulatory engagement in mining and energy
NAMCOR (National Petroleum Corporation of Namibia)	State oil company holding interests in the leading offshore licences, including 10% in Venus and Mopane	Central partner for any oil and gas or downstream energy engagement

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Namport and the Walvis Bay Corridor Group	Port authority and public-private corridor body developing Walvis Bay as a regional logistics gateway	Key counterparts for logistics, port and transit-trade investment

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The Namibia Chamber of Commerce and Industry and the Namibian Employers' Federation are the principal domestic business associations and are active in consultations on investment, labour and empowerment policy. NIPDB organises investor engagement and delegation programmes, and the Walvis Bay Corridor Group convenes port, freight and logistics operators. The EU Delegation, which reports a strong and growing EU–Namibia trade relationship, and the major international oil companies active offshore are useful sources of practical market intelligence. The IMF, World Bank and African Development Bank are engaged on fiscal reform, private-sector development and energy, and the Development Bank of Namibia provides co-financing for local projects.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Namibia suits investors with a medium- to long-term horizon who value stability and a rules-based environment: oil and gas service, logistics and engineering firms positioning ahead of the Venus and Mopane developments; mining and nuclear-fuel investors drawn to world-class uranium assets; renewable energy and green hydrogen developers seeking exceptional solar and wind resources; and agriculture, food-processing and fisheries investors building on strong recent sector growth and access to SACU, EU and US markets. Investors who can bring skills transfer and local partnerships will find the strongest alignment with government priorities.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage NIPDB and track the new investment legislation
Open dialogue with the investment promotion agency and follow the Investment Promotion and Facilitation Bill and SEZ Bill to understand incentives and any sector thresholds.

STEP 2: Position early in the offshore energy supply chain
Map opportunities around Venus and Mopane with operators and NAMCOR, aligning timelines with the expected Q4 2026 and 2027–28 investment decisions.

STEP 3: Build local-content and empowerment plans into project design
Plan training, local supplier and partnership arrangements from the outset, informed by the NEEEF consultations and local-content policy.

STEP 4: Use Walvis Bay as a regional gateway
Assess the port and corridor network for serving Botswana, Zambia, the DRC and South Africa, working with Namport and the Walvis Bay Corridor Group.

STEP 5: Structure currency and financing arrangements
Plan for the rand peg and Bank of Namibia exchange-control procedures, and explore co-financing with development finance institutions and domestic institutional investors.